

The tao of
WΔO

WΔO

Welcome

WΔO

Doug and Laura, founding members of [We Are Open Co-operative](#), have a podcast they called [the Tao of WAO](#). The podcast is “A podcast about the intersection of technology, society, and internet culture - with a dash of philosophy and art for good measure.”

We thought it might be a good idea to actually describe the Tao, or the natural way, of WAO. We put together this presentation to help.



The tao of WAO

“In the Tao Te Ching, Laozi explains that the Tao is not a name for a thing, but the underlying natural order of the universe whose ultimate essence is difficult to circumscribe because it is non-conceptual yet evident in one's being of aliveness.” [Wikipedia](#)

WAO is a collective of individuals who broadly agree on many things. Like any group of people, there are nuanced differences in our positions on the issues of the day, so instead of corporate pronouncements, we have other things. Like this Tao or stuff we've written on [our spirit](#).

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Technology

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**Open source
is preferred,
practicality is
required.**

**Open
standards lead
to a better
world.**

[Support Badge Wiki!](#)
[Navigating](#)

**The wild and
open Internet
is the
platform.**

[10 platforms for
issuing Open Badges](#)

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Society

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Worker owned cooperatives work.

[Do only Yogurt Knitting
Vegans Start
Cooperatives?](#)

[Badging Cooperative
Character](#)

Digital literacies on a never-ending continuum.

[7 Habits of Highly
Successful Virtual
Meetings](#)

[8 Ways to think about
Digital Employability](#)

Participation matters, so model the behaviours.

[Why working openly
on ambitious projects
breeds excitement](#)

[10 Reasons Why
People Contribute to
Open Source](#)

[How to make a
Discovery Process
more Participatory](#)

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Internet Culture

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**Communities
move
mountains.**

[How to build a
Community of Practice](#)

[How Open Source
communities are
evolving](#)

[The Future of the
Commons is an Open
Planet](#)

**Participation
can be
structured.**

[An Architecture of
Participation for
Community growth](#)

[How to Create an AoP
for your Charity Project](#)

[How to Create an AoP
for your Open Source
Project](#)

**Experiment
and fail often
and loudly.**

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Philosophy

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**Learning
happens
everywhere.**

[Greenpeace's Critical
Incident Network](#)

[Exploring community
learning pathways](#)

[Discovering a
Multimodal Training](#)

**Consent-based
governance is
empowering.**

**We bring our
full selves to
work.**

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Art

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**Cheese is
delicious, but
not with the
orange
colour.**

**Bad poetry is
just poetry
that is bad,
and that's ok.**

**The Tao of
WAO isn't a
thing, it is
ephemeral.**